THE HISTORY AND POLITICAL EDUCATION LEARNERS' SEMINAR HELD AT LONDON COLLEGE OF ST. LAWRENCE MAYA ON 28TH MARCH, 2026.

ELEMENT OF CONSTRACT ONE: UNDERSTANDING THE PRE-COLONIAL HISTORY OF EAST AFRICA (PH)

SECTION A ITEM 1. (COMPULSORY ITEMS.)

Item 1.

At independence, East Africa experienced relative peace, stability, economic progress, and social development. However, this situation was short-lived. Soon after, the region—particularly Uganda—became engulfed in political instability, economic disorder, and social tensions.

During a political debate held in your sub-county, a heated discussion arose between concerned citizens and the area Member of Parliament (MP). The concerned citizens argued that Uganda's continued challenges are largely a result of the colonial legacy and historical experiences. On the other hand, the area MP rejected this view, insisting that today's challenges in Uganda and East Africa are mainly a reflection of a new form of foreign control, expressed through financial influence, unfair trade terms, and hidden operations within foreign organizations.

You have been invited to contribute to this debate.

Task

a) Using relevant examples from Uganda, support the concerned citizens' view presented in the scenario.

b) Prepare a well-structured write-up supporting the area MP's perspective.

ITEM 2.

One of the leading government policies today is to promote the study of science subjects in order to realize vision 2040. This is aimed at making the nation more scientific to compete with international standards there by fronting science and ICT subjects since they are the core disciplines through which the government vision can be easily achieved. This has also involved the motivation of science department workers by enhancing their wages to fit the international levels.

However, because of the above policy, learners have been discouraged from studying history and political Education as one of the arts. They don't want to attend lessons, revise and discuss history and political Education, because they have believed that studying it is a waste of time. To address this growing concern, your school administration is concerned about this new trend and has organized an interschool's' discussion to check on it. Your school is the host

and your history and political education has requested you to be the team leader in convincing your colleagues to take history and political Education seriously.

Task.

Consider the role of history in the political, social and economic spheres of life today, write a presentation which you will use during the discussion. In it, educate the government about:

a) **The importance of studying history in Ugandan secondary schools.**
b) **The functions of each source of history.**

ITEM 3

Last year, a group of cultural tourists came to Uganda to study about her people and their cultures and ways of life. They felt so confused on the explanation of the tour guide who told them that the ancient East Africa had many groups of people who belonged to societies which were either centralized or non-centralized.

This made tourists feel there was something they didn't understand especially on how these same East Africans in the same region could be different in cultural setting. They also wonder how they were able to be strong and developed even in that setting. To explain this difference, this ministry of tourism has organized a national tour where they will be sensitizing the cultural tourist in different tourist centres about the difference between centralized and non-centralized societies and why they grew and expanded and you are one of the participants in this tour.

Task.

Write a report in which you explain to the cultural tourists about the;

a) **Difference between centralized and non-centralized societies in East Africa.**

Reasons for the rise and expansion of these societies regardless of different settings.

ITEM 4

During the history exhibition, Senior one learners were introduced to a new subject where the teacher explained about human experiences in the past and how they have helped them to know where they came from, where they are and where they are going. During this lesson, one senior one student remarked, unlike sciences, learning the past is confusing and not easy to rely upon,

causing a debate in the class. On the other hand, senior two was touched by the discussion and asked what is the value of studying the past if it only leaves the senior one learners more confused and questioning its relevance. You have been asked to participate in the interclass youths dialogue to help both senior one and two understand this debate.

Tasks:

(a) Using historical evidence and relevant examples, how would you respond to Senior Ones' concern?
(b) Explain how you would sensitize senior two in the scenario.
(a) Response to Senior One Learners

ITEM 5.

During the early 1990's, there was a new belief which spread across the universe that it was possible that the humanity could have originated from Africa. This theory which emphasized that the oldest bones of human being were discovered at Omo valley and Old Vai Gorge was discouraged among the Europeans who had for so long believed that nothing good can come out of Africa. They had for so long referred to Africa as a dark continent. Their researchers have deliberately refused to make further research about this theory.

However, today many Europeans tourists come and visit historical places in Africa Uganda inclusive to find out for themselves a d confirm the above theory but they are still confused about this theory which they claim has no evidence attached on it which makes the theory a hearsay. They say mere bones cannot prove and confirm anything. They therefore wonder why such places should be preserved yet they keep displays without evidence

Task.

Take into consideration the out of Africa theory and how important historical sites are to Uganda, write a presentation to guide the European tourists about:

a) The reality about the out of Africa theory.
b) The importance of preserving the historical sites in Uganda.

Item 6.

Between AD 1000 and 1500, many Bantu migrated and settled in East Africa where the cushites and Bushmen were already settling as indigenous citizens of those areas. This was because their migration and settlements were caused by changes in the socio-economic and political circumstances within and outside their motherlands. However, due to these migrations, there have been a

lot of complaints by the indigenous people of the lands where they settled, these indigenous owners of the areas say that the new comers have not benefited the at all apart from grabbing their lands and making life uncomfortable for them. Secondly, they wonder why the new comers abruptly migrated into their areas and have not thought of leaving which has left them confused.

The ministry of disaster unpreparedness has organized a countrywide sensitization tour where they expect to engage the indigenous locals of areas with new comers to accept the new comers and co-exist with them. You have been approached to be part of the team and you have been tasked by the minister to prepare a report she will use.

Task.

Looking at the migrations and settlements of people in East Africa, write a report in which you sensitize the indigenous citizen bout the:

a) **The factors which made the Bantu migration into East Africa during the AD 1000-1500 necessary.**
b) **The benefits of their migration and settlement in East African during the AD 1000-1500 on modern East Africa.**

ELEMENT OF CONSTRUCT TWO: UNDERSTANDING THE COLONIAL HISTORY OF EAST AFRICA (CH)

SECTION A ITEM 2. (COMPULSORY ITEMS)

Contains Senior two work.

IItem7.

Between 1945 and 1960, East African countries receive inevitable rise of nationalism and nationalistic action which targeted the acquisition of independence a spirit that grew among East Africans after the World War II if 1939-1945. When the Ex-soldiers of the World War II came back, they returned with nationalistic ideas pumped by the good developments they saw wherever they were deployed to fight and they wished that those changes happen in their respective countries. Today, most East African youth like in Uganda ask themselves about the factors that led to growth of nationalism among the people of 1945-1960 which they do not have today. They also ask themselves the challenges that come with nationalistic movements so that they also start but they have failed.

A radio talk show has been organized and sponsored by the RDC in your district to educate the youth about the factors that could prompt the rise of nationalism and the challenges one may face and you have been contacted to be one of the speakers.

Task.

You are knowledgeable about nationalism, write a speech to the RDC before the radio talk show explaining to the youth about:

a) **The factors which led to the growth of nationalism in East Africa from 1945 to 1960.**
b) **The challenges encountered by the early nationalists that today's nationalist should take note of**.

IITEM8

On 10th March 1900, the most sophiscated agreement ever signed in East Africa between the colonizer and the colonized was sign at Mengo in Uganda. This was a treaty that was signed between the British commissioner in Uganda Sir. Harry Johnstone and the reagents of the infant king of Buganda Kabaka Daudi Chwa namely Apollo Kagwa, Zackaria Kisingiri and Stanslas Mugwanya. This agreement in a sophisticated way sold Uganda to the British because its signing sparked the signing of other agreements in other places like Bunyoro 1933, Tooro 1900, Ankore 1901 which led to total loss of independence of the whole of Uganda.

However, today, many young Ugandans do not understand what could have prompted the Buganda reagents to sign such an agreement due the disastrous effects that came with its signing thereafter. They believe there should have been other ways out and therefore, they are not happy with the reagents for accepting to sign a disastrous agreement. They say that Buganda lost everything she possessed and handed Uganda over to the colonialists.

To end this hatred that exist among the youths, the kingdom of Buganda has organized a palace tour and all schools are welcome but there shall be an inter-school's discussion and your school has chosen you to represent it and the Prime minister will be the last speaker but all issues will rotate around the factors for the signing of the Buganda agreement and the effects of its signing.

Task.

Consider the signing of Buganda agreement and its effects on Buganda and Uganda. Write a presentation which you will use when your school is called on stage, your presentation should contain:

a) **The reasons for the signing of Buganda agreement by 1900.**
b) **Effects of the signing of Buganda agreement on Buganda/Uganda after 1900**.

ITEM 9.

After the second world war of 1939 to 1945, there was massive rise of nationalism between 1945-1962, East Africa and Uganda inclusive rose up and demanded for their independence in various ways. Some used to sit down strikes, boycotts, formation of political parties and demonstrations among others. Due to this pressure, the British decided to give back Ugandans their independence on 9th October 1962 resulting from the acquisition of independence by Tanganyika earlier in 1961 which also forced Kenya to demand for her which she got in 1963 forcing many colonialists to run back to their mother countries and Ugandans were left in charge of their leadership.

Today however, foreigners and foreign tendencies have come back. With the massive pouring of Eritreans, Sudanese, Indians, Somalis among others into Uganda for example, the local people in Uganda are wondering why such people are coming to remind them of the coming of colonialists whose reasons for coming are still not understood up by the local Ugandans to date, the locals say that when the Europeans came, everything they did benefited them not Africans and therefore suggest that they these current foreigners should leave Uganda.

This has prompted your district Chief Administrative Officer and the local authorities to organize district sensitization drive to educate the masses about the issue and you are part of that team.

Task.

The coming Europeans and their activities impacted on Uganda in one way the others. Before the drive, write a report to the CAO and copy it to the local authorities explaining the:

a) **Reasons for which the Europeans came to East Africa during the early 1880's.**
b) **Effects of European activities on Uganda today.**

ELEMENT OF CONSTRUCT THREE. UNDERSTANDING THE POST-COLONIAL HISTORY AND POLITICAL AFFAIRS OF AFRICA. (PC)

SECTION B. (Contains optional items.)

(SENIOR 3 AND 4 WORK)

ATTEMPT ONE ITEM.

(This section has two items; learners MUST attempt one item.)

ITEM 10

Throughout history, development and underdevelopment have been used as key ideas to interpret the progress of countries, continents, and regions. However, since the period of the Cold War, some countries have developed faster than others. For example, Singapore, South Korea, and Japan—once ranked among the poorest countries in Asia and the world—gradually and steadily transformed from third-world economies into some of the richest nations globally.

This economic success, which now sets these Asian Tigers apart from many East African countries, has been attributed to a combination of political, social, and economic policies. Most importantly, it has been linked to strong leadership and stable political organization demonstrated by leaders across these countries.

During a recent session of the United Nations General Assembly in New York City, the progress of the Asian Tigers was reviewed in comparison with East Africa's path to development. The Assembly observed that Uganda's current challenges are largely the result of both external and internal factors, especially the political weaknesses of its leaders since independence.

As a recommendation, the Assembly praised the development models of the Asian Tigers and called upon Uganda's current leaders to adopt similar approaches in order to promote national development.

Task

a) **Using historical evidence and examples, support the position of the United Nations General Assembly as presented in the scenario.**
b) **Explain to the meeting what the UN's advice means in the context of the scenario.**

ITEM 11

As a way of delivering good and efficient leadership and social services to Ugandans, the constitution of Uganda provides for decentralized and local governments which is further consolidated in what came to be known as the **Local Government Act of 1997 article 181(4).** This section provides for existence of democratically elected local governments running from local council five (LCV) to local council one (LCI) to ease the flow of information and activities between the central and local communities.

This system has proved that it can efficiently provide good leadership and development of local communities since leaders are living and operating with in the communities. It spearheads patriotism and nationalism which are vocal and vital for the development of a country. However, it has continuously become a massive outcry, members of these communities have failed to understand how these local council operate to smoothly deliver their services to the expected results. Furthermore, these governments have always cried out the many challenges and problems they face during their work but the government has failed to address them.

Task.

Basing on work or local councils and the challenges they face in their endeavours to pursue positive results for the betterment of their communities and the country at large, write a presentation about:

a) **constitutionally gazetted activities of any three local council levels of administration in Uganda.**
b) **the challenges the above local councils encounter during the execution of their mandates and provide ways in which the government can solve them.**

ITEM 12.

Between 1939-1945, East African states which were also under colonial rule were mandated to participate in the World War II on the side of their colonial masters. After the World War II, those Africans who participated in that war in different parts of the world came back with different political ideas in what came to be known as the Rise of Nationalism between 1946-1960 characterized by mass political awareness, formation of political blocks and movements and parties all pointing at acquisition of independence.

Today, the rise of nationalism and the political parties which were formed by the Nationalists have led to massive political changes in many East African and

African states through acquisition of their independence. However, this has remained a confusing question, some Ugandans for example have lost morale in political parties saying that most of them lost their cardinal agendas while others are money making ventures and the challenges the appropriators of these parties faced have been forgotten by their successors.

To solve this confusion, the Inter-Party Organization for Dialogue (IPOD) has organized a political awareness at Kololo ceremonial grounds to sensitize the masses about the reasons for the formations of political parties and the challenges they face today to bridge the gap between the masses and the parties and you will be one of the speakers.

Task.

Consider the work of political parties in Uganda today, write a speech that you present at the awareness campaign. In it, sensitize the masses about;

a) **the factors for the formation of political movements in Uganda.**
b) **The problems faced by political parties in Uganda today.**

Item 13:

Today, Uganda is celebrating its independence at Hoima International Stadium. The celebrations reviewed Uganda's journey to independence, which began in 1894 and continued into the 1960s when Apollo Milton Obote was handed over instruments of power by the British government.

During the celebrations, the President appreciated the contributions of early resistors such as Omukama Kabalega and Kabaka Mwanga II, praising them for laying the foundation for later nationalist struggles led by Ignatius Kangave Musaazi, Benedicto Kiwanuka, and later Obote

However, the Resident District Commissioner (RDC) of Hoima sought to understand how Obote's Uganda People's Congress (UPC) and his political activities contributed to Uganda's independence victory on 9th October 1962. You have been tasked with preparing a write-up to help both the President and the RDC understand this historical journey clearly.

Task

a) **Using historical evidence and examples, support the President's view in the scenario.**
b) **Explain, in a well-structured write-up, how Obote and the Uganda People's Congress contributed to Uganda's independence**

ITEM 14.

For many decades, the problem of refugees in East Africa which started as early as 1965 escalated and caused a refugee crisis in countries that neighboured destabilized countries. People fled in millions to the neighbouring countries looking for peaceful places to settle as their countries sought peace. For example, the NRA wars of 1981 to 1986, FRONASA of 1979 of Museveni and the Joseph Kony instabilities in Northern Uganda among others forced many Ugandans to flee to peaceful countries, the Bududa landslides in Eastern Uganda in 2010 which killed about 300 people.

Today, the problem of refugees has escalated following the outbreak of civil, political and ethnic violence in countries like DR. Congo, South Sudan, Sudan, Somalia, Central African Republican, Somalia, Rwanda 1994, Eritrea among others. Such instabilities have forced hundreds of thousands of people to pour in Uganda. Uganda today hosts nearly two million refugees (2000,0000 refugees). Many Ugandans have asked themselves and put the government to explain why this refugee crisis is becoming too much and also asking how Uganda benefits from this problem and finally thy want all refugees kicked out of Uganda.

The office of the Prime Minister of Uganda (OPM) seeks to answer the above unanswered questions by Ugandans. A workshop has been organized at the Kampala Serena and Conference Center and different schools and Universities have been asked to send in their representatives and your Deputy Academics has decided that you represent your school.

Task.

Before the workshop, read through history of the escalating scarge of refugees in East Africa and write a report in which you address the:

a) **Causes of the escalating scourge of the refugee crisis in Uganda today.**
b) **Effects of the refugee crisis on Uganda**.

Item 15

For many generations, communities in East Africa, Africa, and the wider world have experienced different forms of conflict at different times—civil wars, religious wars, coups, inter-community conflicts, and interstate wars. These conflicts often lead to loss of life, political instability, economic crises, and underdevelopment.On June 18, 2024, for example, in Kenya, a peaceful youth demonstration against the proposed Finance Bill 2024 turned violent. The youth protesters, popularly known as “Gen Z,” accused the president and the Kenyan government of breaking promises made to the people. The situation worsened when Parliament passed the bill, which increased taxes on everyday products.The youth blamed the three branches of government—the

executive, judiciary, and legislature—for failing to protect citizens' rights. Protesters attacked and looted government property at Parliament, including the Speaker's Golden Mace, and also targeted Uganda House and Uganda's Embassy. The protests spread nationwide, affecting more than ten towns across Kenya.This situation attracted attention from Kenyan authorities, the East African region, and the global community. The Kenyan authorities sought to understand why youth demonstrations are increasing in the region, while delegates from the East African Community advised the Kenyan government to adopt Pan-African principles in order to resolve such conflicts.

You have been invited to participate in two forums to guide on this matter.

c) Task

d) a) Using evidence from the scenario, educate the Kenyan authorities on the causes of the protests.

b) Explain how the recommendation of the East African Community delegates can be applied in the scenario.

END.